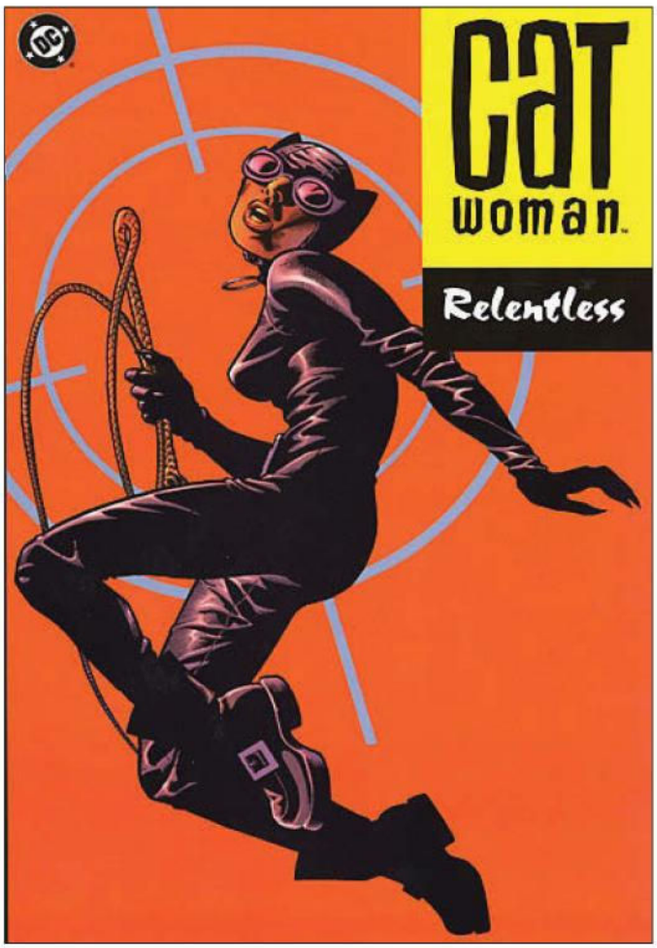
CATWOMAN: RELENTLESS

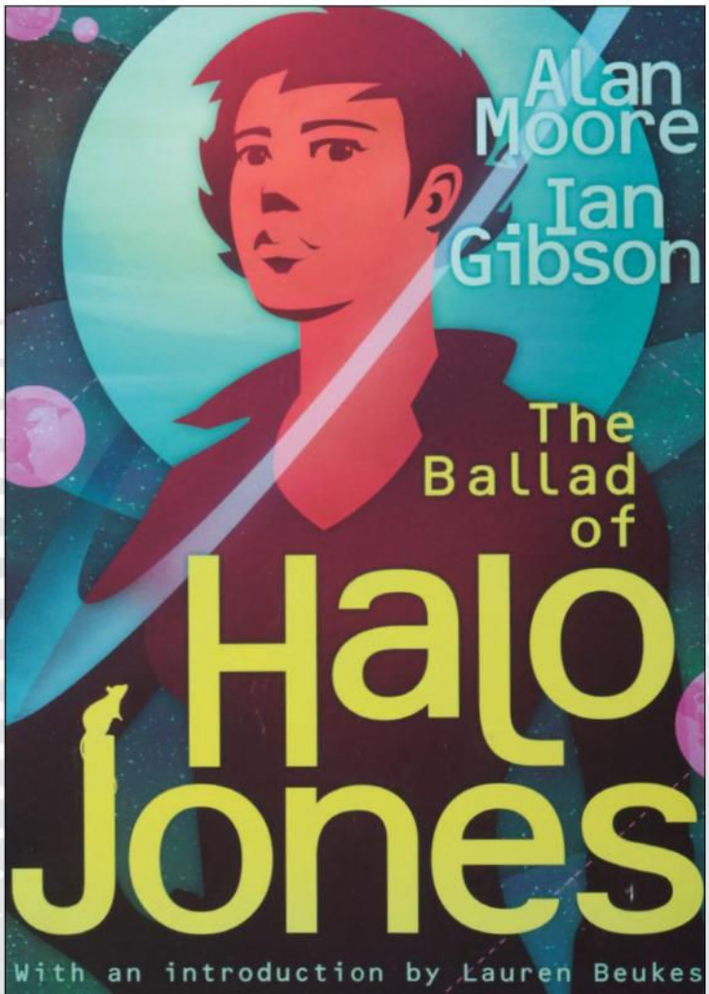
Details **Originally published** Catwoman #12-19 (2005) **Publisher** DC **Writer** Ed Brubaker **Artists** Cameron Stewart, Javier Pulido, JG Jones **Collected in** Catwoman: Relentless **Available digitally** Comixology



Long before the 'sexy sexy' *Catwoman* of the New 52, we had Ed Brubaker's excellent noir *Catwoman*, teaming Selina Kyle with gone-to-seed PI Slam Bradley and recovering heroin addict Holly Robinson. Initially with Darwyn Cooke on art duties, this Catwoman was socially conscious, smart, capable and utterly ruthless if you hurt someone she cared about.



The 'Relentless' arc pitted Selina against Black Mask – a minor *Batman* villain given the freedom to grow into a terrifying menace in the pages of *Catwoman*. 'Relentless' is the best possible name for the arc; the hits just kept on coming for Selina, with her own sister getting pulled into her game of cat and mouse with Black Mask. This arc is a brutal, breathless and exhausting read, with wonderful art and tight plotting. You'll find yourself wondering why, when Catwoman can be this good, she's not heading up Hollywood films of her own.



THE BALLAD OF HALO JONES

Details **Originally published** 2000 AD Progs #376-466 (1984-86) **Publisher** Rebellion **Writer** Alan Moore **Artist** Ian Gibson **Collected in** The Complete Ballad Of Halo Jones **Available digitally** Comixology

In the early Eighties, Alan Moore was vocal in wanting to bring a woman-led story to sci-fi anthology *2000 AD*. *The Ballad Of Halo Jones* was to be the story of a woman in the future – not particularly heroic or remarkable, but a star nonetheless.

The lack of heroism is somewhat fitting for an anthology best known for *Judge Dredd*, but Moore was also attempting to do more, to break down the stereotypes of women in comics as half-naked and as an adornment to the male cast.

Halo Jones broke the mould, becoming a success with male and female readers alike. A cracking sci-fi adventure story in a realistic yet mind-boggling future universe of interstellar travel and all-too-familiar wars, it's the story of an ordinary young woman who decides to put herself out into the bigger universe and struggles with the consequences. It's one of the bravest stories *2000 AD* ever told.

